left Wheeler with only one option: he would attempt to secure Bohr's own blessing for Everett's work before endorsing it himself.



Figure 6.3. Wheeler (right), with Einstein (left) and Nobel Prize winner Hideki Yukawa in Princeton, 1954.

In mid-1956, Wheeler had his chance. He was invited to a visiting post at Leiden University, in the Netherlands, for several months. Once Wheeler had settled in there, he sent Everett's thesis draft, appropriately titled *Wave Mechanics Without Probability*, to Bohr, along with an introductory note. Tripping over himself to excuse any possible perception of Everett as contradicting Bohr, Wheeler wrote that "the title itself… like so many of the ideas in it, need further analysis and rephrasing." Wheeler himself soon followed in person and discussed Everett's thesis with Bohr, Petersen, and others in Copenhagen for several days.

Writing to Everett after his Copenhagen visit, Wheeler at first sounded hopeful and clear-eyed about the work yet to be done. "[Bohr and Petersen and I] had three long and strong discussions about it.… Stating conclusions briefly, your beautiful wave function formalism of course remains unshaken; but all of us feel that the real issue is the words that are to be attached to the quantities of the formalism." Wheeler implored his student to come to Copenhagen himself and resolve these problems, and offered to pay half of Everett's steamship fare to make it happen. "[Bohr] would welcome very much a several weeks' visit from you to thrash this out.…